Indian government was less obsessed by the Soviet Russian threat during the post-war years than the Home government was.

When it came to Afghanistan, things were also gradually moving in Britain's favour and just as with Persia, much of this appeared to be as a result of waning Bolshevik influence. The main problem with Soviet-Afghan relations throughout this period was, effectively, that each wanted to be the champion of Islam in Central Asia. Soviet Russia wanted to harness Muslim discontent in the region and use it, initially to bring down imperialist Britain, but also to extend Communism through Asia. For this cause, the Bolshevik regime was ready to subvert its more overt Marxist ideals and make alliances with revolutionary Muslim groups, such as the Jadids and Young Bukharans. For his part, Amanullah was ambitions to make his mark on the world stage and developing an image as protector of Muslims was one such way. The first attempt by Amanullah to harness pan-Islamism had been supporting the hijrat. Another opportunity appeared to present itself with the dissolution of the Caliph. In February 1922 Reading was warning London that there was a danger the emir would put forward a claim to be the new Caliph. An aggrandised Afghanistan with its leader presuming to be head of Islam, however, would cause untold problems for the Indian government.[159] Whether Amanullah seriously considered becoming the next Caliph is difficult to say, although it appears he had the support of some of his subjects.[160] Either way, as Dobbs pointed out: 'Afghanistan will keep her eyes fixed on her Indian and Central Asian frontiers, ready to move forward in one or other direction on a certitude of real weakness.'[161]

Luckily, the emir seemed to have learnt his lesson from 1919 regarding invading India. Instead, a more promising venture appeared to lie in extending Afghanistan's influence into Central Asia. For one thing, affairs were not going entirely in Soviet Russia's favour by 1922. The treatment of Muslims by the Tashkent Soviet in the early days of its existence had considerably soured relations between the two. Muslims had been excluded from the Soviet, and when they had then tried to set up their own government in Kokand, the Tashkent regime had attacked and destroyed it.[162] The Kokand massacre had been followed by an eruption of Muslim discontent centred in the Fergana region and the creation of the Basmachi